Setting up your workspace

As defined previously, the workspace discussed in this section refers to the deployment instance. Here, we will discuss workspace setup recommendations, project setup files, and download instructions for each dataset used throughout this book.

There is comprehensive documentation on deploying your workspace for the first time. If you do not already have a Databricks account and deployed workspace, then you have a couple of places to start from. One method is going into your cloud account and activating Databricks through the marketplaces. Another method is to begin on the Databricks website. For more advanced users, consider using Terraform. Given the amount of documentation and the ever-changing world of technology, we leave the exercise of activating a workspace up to you.

Once we have a workspace deployed, we can begin setting it up. Generally, we start with user groups and governance. The experience of setting up Unity Catalog is frequently updated for simplicity. Therefore, we recommend you watch the latest video documentation on how to do so (see *Further reading*). The process is the same, regardless of the data persona using the platform. Please be sure to complete metastore and governance setup before going forward.

Kaggle setup

You will need a Kaggle account to download the Kaggle datasets we'll be using, which require an API token for authentication. There is an official Kaggle API, but, there are numerous other ways to connect to Kaggle to download data and interact with the Kaggle site as well. All methods require downloading your API credentials file, `kaggle.json`, from the Kaggle website. Before downloading data, you need to make your credentials accessible. Here are three methods for accomplishing this:

- **Option 1**: Upload the `kaggle.json` file to your project folder. If you choose to do this, be aware that your credentials are viewable to others, even if only admins. Also, add `kaggle.json` to your `.gitignore` file to prevent committing your credentials to the repository and ensure you do not commit your credentials to a Git repository.
- **Option 2**: Paste your credentials into a notebook with the same concerns as option one. Keeping secret API keys in your Databricks notebook is far from best practice, but it is the simplest option and you can lock down your notebook access and add a configuration notebook to your `.gitignore` file to prevent committing your credentials to the repository. However, the ability to remove other users' access may not be in your control, depending on your role. Furthermore, in general, admins can see all files.

```
import os
os.environ['kaggle_username'] = 'YOUR KAGGLE USERNAME HERE'

os.environ['kaggle_key'] = 'YOUR KAGGLE KEY HERE'
```

Figure 2.10 – Passing user credentials to the notebook